FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

Unit 8: Sounds from Arabic and Persian عربی فارسی کے حرف

1 In this unit



Six letters common in everyday Urdu loanwords; ع mostly a vowel seat; ح same sound as ہ.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

ح ع غ خ ق ف

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ف	**fe** فے 'f' in fat	small loop, then the bowl leftwards; the dot last	qāf
ق	**qāf** قاف a 'k' made far back in the throat (Arabic loanwords)	small loop, then the bowl leftwards; the dots last	fe, kāf
خ	**k̲he** خے 'ch' in Scottish loch	small head stroke leftwards, then the round bowl below; dot last	jīm, che, baṛī ḥe
غ	**g̲hain** غین a gargled 'g', like the French 'r'	small c at the top, then the bowl; the dot last	‘ain
ع	**‘ain** عین in Urdu it mostly just carries the vowel written around it (عمر umar)	small c at the top, then the bowl	g̲hain
ح	**baṛī ḥe** بڑی حے 'h' in hat (Arabic loanwords)	small head stroke leftwards, then the round bowl below	jīm, che, k̲he, choṭī he (gol he)

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write**: one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes**: circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters**: standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match**: word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice**: words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation**: the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check**: 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise** effort: “you started on the right”, “good dots”. One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time’s letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.